MLAs who had defected to the BJP in 2019. It found alternative candidates in their respective seats and took utmost care that no defector who wanted to return, like Filipe Nery Rodrigues and Aleixo Reginaldo Lourenco, was fielded. If the Congress has failed to snatch power from the BJP, it is largely because of the lack of a credible leader. It relied on Lobo to damage the BJP, but the move backfired.

Among the survivors, the Maharashtrawadi Gomantak Party (MGP) deserves special mention. The party lost two of its three MLAs to the BJP and was in danger of being wiped out in the state. Instead, the Hindutva-oriented party managed to win two seats despite its alliance with the "anti-Hindu" TMC. The MGP has announced its unconditional support to the BJP, hoping for a better deal. An analysis of the results shows that the party cornered the votes of the upper-caste Hindus, its traditional supporters, despite joining hands with the TMC, which is locally perceived as anti-Hindu. Newcomer Revolutionary Goans Party (RGP), which secured 10 per cent votes, ended up helping the BJP in dividing opposition votes, says MGP leader Sudin Dhavalikar.

After a wait of five years, the AAP, with a win in two seats, opened its account in Goa. It sees its victory in Benaulim and Velim as a mandate for clean slate candidates and its growing influence among Catholics. The TMC, however, failed to make an impression.

Sawant has announced that three independents—Chandrakant Shetye, Lourenco and Antonio Vaz—have pledged unconditional support to the BJP. He fell short of his target of 22 seats, but Sawant has become the second leader after the late Manohar Parrikar to secure a majority for the BJP. Sulakshana Sawant, the BJP women's wing state president and the CM's wife, said: "Our victory is a tribute to Manoharbhai Parrikar. I hope the CM [Pramod] will walk on the path laid by him."

The next challenge before Sawant is portfolio allocation. The ambitious Rane has got a shot in the arm with two seats within the Rane family. Sawant's future moves are likely to be in accordance with those of Rane's. ■

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DON'T USE MOBILE PHONE WHILE DRIVING



With the advent of mobile phones, life has really changed. People are getting connected with one another thanks to them but there is still some harm in using them when you must focus on something else at hand.

When you drive, it is important to pay attention and focus on the road ahead. If your senses are focused elsewhere (in this case: on using your phone), then there can be disastrous consequences for not only you, but also for other drivers around you.

The risks associated with using your phone or texting while driving have been publicized time and again. Numerous accidents have occurred solely because people were distracted by their gadgets.

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Needless to say, today's technology provides you with a plethora of safety measures. So, use them and invest in them as they are truly life savers.

